FIELDIQ

AI-Powered Youth Sports Management Platform

Confidential Business Plan • 2026

Concept Agentic AI platform replacing the manual labor of youth sports team management — scheduling, coordination, and communication.	**Target Launch** Q4 2026 — MVP beta with 10–20 youth soccer teams in the DMV metro area.
Founder Sole developer/founder with full-stack and cloud infrastructure expertise (Kotlin, Node.js, Kubernetes, AWS, DevOps).	**Revenue Model** Freemium team subscriptions, club licensing, payment processing fees, and AI Concierge premium tier.

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

1. Executive Summary

FieldIQ is an AI-first youth sports management platform built to eliminate the operational burden carried by the millions of volunteer team managers in recreational and competitive youth sports across the United States. Unlike legacy platforms such as TeamSnap or SportsEngine — which are passive organizational tools requiring a human to perform all coordination work — FieldIQ deploys autonomous AI agents that actively negotiate schedules, book fields, coordinate volunteers, and communicate with parents on behalf of the team.

The product is founded on a real, validated pain point: a volunteer parent acting as team manager spends dozens of hours per season manually managing scheduling conflicts, chasing RSVPs, coordinating with opposing teams, and navigating field availability — tools that require them to do all the cognitive labor while providing only a place to record the results. FieldIQ inverts this model.

Mission Statement

To give every volunteer youth sports manager their time back — by replacing coordination work with intelligent, autonomous agents that handle scheduling, communication, and logistics end-to-end.

Key Highlights

- $4.5B+ addressable market across youth sports management software and adjacent services
- 30M+ youth athletes in the US, served by largely volunteer team managers using outdated tools
- AI Scheduling Agent as the core differentiator — negotiates game times cross-team, a capability no existing platform offers
- Network effect moat: every team onboarded creates scheduling friction for non-users, driving viral adoption
- Sole-developer MVP targeting sub-$800/month infrastructure at launch, scaling to $3,000–6,000/month at 10,000 active teams
- Primary revenue from club/org licensing ($150–500/mo), team subscriptions ($12–18/mo), and payment processing (2.5%)

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

2. Problem Statement

The Volunteer Manager Burden

In recreational and competitive youth sports, team management is almost universally performed by unpaid parent volunteers. A typical season manager for a youth soccer team (8–12 players) performs the following work manually, with little to no tool support:

- Coordinates practice and game scheduling across 15–25 families with conflicting calendars
- Negotiates game rescheduling with opposing team managers when conflicts arise
- Sources and books field time through parks & rec departments or club directors
- Sends game reminders, cancellation notices, and RSVP follow-ups — often multiple times per family
- Coordinates volunteers for snack duty, carpools, and tournament logistics
- Acts as the communication hub between coaches, parents, the club, and opposing teams

Existing platforms like TeamSnap ONE, SportsEngine, PlayMetrics, and LeagueApps provide a structured place to record this information — with varying degrees of AI assist for internal tasks. However, none perform cross-team work autonomously. The manager must still initiate every action involving a party outside their own team, chase every confirmation, and resolve every scheduling conflict manually. New entrant Otto Sport AI (Jan 2026, $16.5M) targets this space with a club-focused AI OS, but its Otto Pilot feature handles inbound parent Q&A and admin tasks — not cross-team negotiation. FieldIQ's founding differentiator remains uncontested.

The Core Pain Point

When a game needs to be rescheduled, the manager must: (1) check family availability manually, (2) contact the opposing team's manager via text/email, (3) negotiate a mutually available time, (4) confirm field availability, (5) notify both teams. This process can take days and 20+ messages. FieldIQ reduces this to a single AI-initiated workflow resolved in minutes.

Why Existing Tools Fall Short

Otto Sport AI (Jan 2026, $16.5M)	AI OS for clubs/tourneys	Otto Pilot chatbot; comms/admin automation	None — no cross-team negotiation yet	Chat-focused, not full agentic scheduling
Fastbreak AI Compete (Jun 2025)	Tournament AI Engine	Full AI engine for fair matchups + venues	None — internal tournament bracket only	Tournament/league ops only; no team-day mgmt
LeagueApps	League/Tournament	AI Schedule Importer + drag-drop optimizer	None — human-led import, not autonomous	Aggressive AI roadmap; has club distribution
FieldIQ	AI-First Agent	Fully automated	Cross-platform AI negotiation	Full agentic layer

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

3. Product & Solution

Platform Overview

FieldIQ is a mobile-first application with a lightweight web companion. The product is organized into two layers: a standard team management interface (roster, schedule, messaging) and an AI agent layer that actively performs coordination work on behalf of the manager.

Core AI Agents

Scheduling Agent

- Ingests player and parent availability via calendar sync (Google Calendar, Apple Calendar, Outlook)
- Detects conflicts across all parties automatically and proposes optimized game/practice windows
- Communicates with the opposing team's FieldIQ instance to negotiate mutual availability — entirely cross-platform
- Monitors weather APIs and proactively proposes reschedule options when conditions require cancellation
- Sends approval requests and executes once manager quorum is confirmed

Field & Facility Agent

- Maintains a live database of local field availability through parks & rec integrations and private facility APIs
- Proactively books fields based on confirmed schedule — no manager intervention required
- Monitors for facility cancellations and auto-reassigns to alternatives with manager notification

Communication Agent

- Drafts and sends RSVPs, reminders, and cancellation notices in plain language tuned to the audience
- Follows up automatically with non-responding parents after configurable intervals
- Multilingual support (Spanish, Portuguese, etc.) — a significantly underserved need in youth soccer
- Differentiates communication style by recipient: coach vs. parent vs. club director

Roster & Volunteer Agent

- Tracks snack assignments, carpool coordination, and volunteer slots with fair rotation logic
- Sends reminders and fills unfilled volunteer slots through automated outreach

Game Day Agent

- Morning-of reminders with field address, parking notes, and uniform color
- Real-time attendance confirmation tracking — surfaces no-shows to coach automatically
- Post-game recap and availability check-in trigger for next event

Network Effect Moat

The cross-team scheduling negotiation feature only delivers full value when both teams are on FieldIQ. Every time a FieldIQ manager schedules against a non-FieldIQ team, the friction differential is immediately visible. This creates a strong organic sales pressure: managers recommend the platform to opposing teams they coordinate with frequently. Every game is a conversion touchpoint.

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

4. Market Analysis

Total Addressable Market

Segment	US Size	Relevant Population	Estimated TAM
Youth Athletes (US)	~30 million	All organized sports	Top of funnel
Youth Soccer Specifically	~4 million	Primary launch vertical	1.5M teams
Youth Sports Mgmt Software	Industry revenue	Existing software spend	$1.5B (2025)
Adjacent: Payment Processing	Seasonal fees collected	2.5% of transaction volume	$500M+ opportunity
Adjacent: Field Booking	Facility reservation market	Parks & rec + private	$300M+ opportunity

Target Customer Segments — Prioritized

Primary: Competitive & Travel Soccer Clubs (Launch Revenue Target)

These are organized business operations charging $2,000–$8,000 per player per season. They have paid directors and coaching staff, existing software spend (SportsEngine, PlayMetrics), and strong motivation to reduce manager churn and improve scheduling reliability. This is the realistic enterprise buyer.

Secondary: Municipal Parks & Recreation Departments

City rec departments manage dozens of teams, multiple fields, and seasonal registrations. They have actual operating budgets, paid staff accountable for outcomes, and compliance needs. A single city contract could represent 40–80 teams.

Tertiary: Tournament Operators

Weekend tournament operators coordinate 50–200 teams in 2–3 days. Scheduling is their entire operational challenge. FieldIQ's scheduling agent is purpose-built for this exact problem and could command premium pricing as a dedicated tournament management SKU.

Acquisition Channel: Rec League Volunteer Managers

This is not the primary revenue segment, but it is the critical acquisition and network-building layer. Rec managers are offered free or near-free access. Their adoption creates the scheduling network that makes upselling to clubs and tournament operators natural and data-driven.

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

5. Business Model & Monetization

Revenue Streams

1. Team Subscriptions (Freemium)

Free tier covers basic roster, messaging, and schedule display. Paid tiers unlock AI agents.

Tier	Price	Features	Target
Free	$0/month	Roster, basic schedule, messaging	Rec league managers — acquisition
Manager Pro	$14/month	All AI agents, calendar sync, auto-reminders	Engaged rec managers
AI Concierge	$32/month	Fully hands-off mode — manager only approves	Burned-out managers, competitive teams

2. Club / Organization Licensing

Sold to club directors and rec departments — not individual managers. Includes admin dashboards, compliance tracking, and aggregate reporting.

Tier	Price	Teams Included	Best For
Club Starter	$150/month	Up to 10 teams	Small competitive clubs
Club Pro	$350/month	Up to 30 teams	Mid-size travel clubs
Club Enterprise	$600+/month	Unlimited teams + custom integrations	Large clubs, rec departments
Tournament SKU	$200–800 per event	Single tournament, unlimited teams	Tournament operators

3. Payment Processing Fees

FieldIQ handles collection of registration fees, tournament entry, uniform orders, and season dues. A 2.5% processing fee on all transactions creates a revenue stream that scales with platform activity, not seat count.

- Average seasonal fee per player: ~$200 recreational, ~$2,500+ competitive
- At 10,000 active players paying $200: $200,000 collected → $5,000/season in processing revenue
- At 50,000 players at blended $400 average: $20M collected → $500,000/year from processing alone

4. Local Sponsorship Marketplace

Geo-targeted advertising from local businesses (sporting goods, orthodontists, photography, tutoring centers) served at the team and age-group level. Opt-in only. Not a primary revenue source at launch but a meaningful add at scale.

5. Field/Facility Partner Network

Private facilities and parks & rec departments pay a small listing/referral fee to be included in the FieldIQ field booking network. Positioned as demand generation — a source of guaranteed bookings in exchange for priority placement and API integration.

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

6. Infrastructure & Cloud Cost Analysis

As a sole developer, infrastructure cost management is critical. The platform requires: a mobile-friendly API backend, an AI orchestration layer, real-time push notifications, a relational database, and a message queue for async agent tasks. Below is a realistic cost analysis across major providers at each stage of scale.

Architecture Components Required

- API Backend — Kotlin Spring Boot or Node.js/TypeScript REST + WebSocket layer
- AI Orchestration — LLM API calls (Anthropic or OpenAI) + LangGraph or similar agent framework
- Primary Database — PostgreSQL (relational: users, teams, schedules, events)
- Message Queue / Async Agents — background job processing for scheduling negotiations, reminders
- Push Notifications — Firebase Cloud Messaging (FCM) or APNs
- Object Storage — profile images, uploaded documents
- CDN — static assets, mobile app delivery
- Calendar API Integration layer — Google, Apple, Microsoft

Provider Comparison by Stage

Stage 1: MVP / Beta (0–500 teams, ~$0 revenue)

Goal: minimize burn, validate product-market fit. Prioritize simplicity over scalability.

Provider	Est. Monthly Cost	Strengths	Weaknesses
DigitalOcean	$80–$180/mo	Simple pricing, App Platform PaaS, managed Postgres included, developer-friendly	Less mature AI/ML tooling, smaller support ecosystem
Linode / Akamai	$60–$150/mo	Cheapest raw compute, straightforward VPS pricing, good for budget-conscious MVP	No managed AI services, more DIY required, smaller ecosystem
Railway / Render	$50–$120/mo	Near-zero DevOps overhead, ideal for solo dev, auto-deploy from Git	Less control, cost can spike, not ideal past early stage
AWS (Frugal Config)	$150–$300/mo	ECS Fargate + RDS Postgres + SQS — full stack, scales naturally	More complex to configure; cost management requires attention
GCP	$130–$280/mo	Cloud Run is excellent for containerized APIs, BigQuery for future analytics	Steeper IAM learning curve, billing complexity

Recommendation for MVP

Start on Railway or Render for pure speed to ship, or DigitalOcean App Platform if you want more infrastructure control. Given your existing AWS expertise with ECS/Fargate/RDS, AWS on a lean config ($150–$300/mo) is the strongest choice if you want a clear migration path to scale without re-architecture. Avoid over-engineering at this stage.

Stage 2: Early Growth (500–5,000 teams, ~$5K–$30K MRR)

Goal: prove retention, begin club licensing sales. Infrastructure needs to handle real-time agent tasks, notification volume, and multi-tenant data isolation.

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

Component	AWS	GCP	DigitalOcean
API Compute	ECS Fargate: $200–400/mo	Cloud Run: $150–350/mo	App Platform: $100–250/mo
PostgreSQL DB	RDS t3.medium: $80–150/mo	Cloud SQL: $90–160/mo	Managed PG: $50–100/mo
Message Queue	SQS: $15–40/mo	Cloud Pub/Sub: $15–40/mo	Managed Redis: $30–60/mo
AI API Costs (LLM)	$300–1,200/mo (Claude/GPT usage)	$300–1,200/mo	$300–1,200/mo
Storage + CDN	S3 + CloudFront: $30–60/mo	GCS + Cloud CDN: $25–55/mo	Spaces + CDN: $20–40/mo
Total Estimate	$625–1,850/mo	$580–1,805/mo	$500–1,650/mo

Note on AI API Costs

LLM usage is the most variable and potentially largest cost. Agent calls (scheduling negotiation, communication drafting) should be designed with token efficiency in mind. Caching frequent agent responses, batching non-urgent tasks, and using smaller/faster models for routine operations (reminders, RSVP follow-ups) versus larger models only for complex negotiation will be critical to maintaining unit economics.

Stage 3: Scale (5,000–20,000+ teams, $50K+ MRR)

At this stage, AWS becomes the clear recommendation. The managed services ecosystem (SQS, SNS, RDS Multi-AZ, ElastiCache, CloudWatch) provides the operational maturity a solo developer needs to maintain infrastructure without a dedicated DevOps team. GCP is a strong alternative if analytics and ML become a core product feature.

Component	Estimated Monthly Cost
ECS Fargate (multi-service: API, agent workers, scheduler)	$600–1,200
RDS PostgreSQL Multi-AZ (db.t3.large)	$300–600
ElastiCache Redis (caching + session)	$150–300
SQS + SNS (message queuing + push notification dispatch)	$50–150
S3 + CloudFront (storage + CDN)	$80–160
AI API Costs (LLM — Claude/GPT at scale)	$1,500–4,000
Monitoring (CloudWatch + Datadog or Grafana Cloud)	$100–250
Misc (Secrets Manager, Route53, WAF, data transfer)	$100–200
TOTAL ESTIMATED	$2,880–6,860/month

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

Infrastructure Recommendation Summary

Stage	Recommended Provider	Est. Monthly Cost	Rationale
MVP / Beta	AWS (lean) or DigitalOcean	$150–$300	Leverage existing AWS/ECS expertise; avoid re-architecture later
Early Growth	AWS	$600–1,850	SQS for agent tasks, RDS scaling, familiarity = faster iteration
Scale	AWS primary	$3,000–6,860	Full managed services ecosystem; operational maturity without DevOps hire

LLM / AI Cost Optimization Strategies

- Use Claude Haiku or GPT-4o-mini for routine tasks (reminders, RSVP follow-ups, standard notifications) — 10–20x cheaper than full models
- Reserve Claude Sonnet/Opus for complex scheduling negotiation and conflict resolution
- Cache common agent responses (e.g., standard cancellation messages, field booking confirmations)
- Batch non-urgent agent tasks (end-of-day reminder generation vs. real-time execution)
- Implement per-team token budgets to prevent runaway costs from high-activity teams
- Build a hybrid rule-based + AI system: use deterministic logic for simple scheduling, LLM only for ambiguous conflict resolution

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

7. Financial Projections

The following projections are based on a conservative adoption model targeting youth soccer in the DMV metro area as a launchpad, expanding nationally by Year 2. Assumes sole developer with no employee payroll and minimal marketing spend through Year 1 (organic + word-of-mouth via the scheduling network effect).

Revenue Projections (Conservative)

Metric	Year 1 (Beta→Launch)	Year 2	Year 3
Active Teams (free)	200	1,500	5,000
Paying Teams (Manager Pro)	40	400	1,800
AI Concierge Teams	10	120	600
Club Licenses	2	15	50
Monthly Team Sub Revenue	$680	$6,640	$34,200
Monthly Club License Revenue	$400	$3,750	$15,000
Annual Payment Processing Revenue	$2,400	$28,000	$180,000
Total ARR (End of Year)	$13,056	$125,880	$579,600

Cost Projections

Cost Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Infrastructure (cloud)	$3,600	$18,000	$54,000
AI API Costs (LLM)	$2,400	$18,000	$48,000
3rd Party APIs (calendar, weather, mapping)	$600	$2,400	$6,000
Domain, SSL, Monitoring, Tools	$1,200	$1,800	$2,400
Legal / Incorporation	$2,500	$1,000	$1,000
Marketing / App Store Fees	$1,000	$5,000	$15,000
Total Annual Costs	$11,300	$46,200	$126,400

Break-Even Analysis

At the projected Year 1 revenue ramp, FieldIQ reaches cash-flow neutral at approximately month 14–18, assuming minimal founder salary draw and operating as an S-corp pass-through. The low infrastructure cost floor ($150–$300/month at MVP) means the financial risk during development is limited primarily to opportunity cost and development time.

Unit Economics Target

Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) via organic/network channels: <$15 per team. Lifetime Value (LTV) of a Manager Pro team at $14/mo with 18-month average retention: $252. LTV:CAC ratio of 16:1 —

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

extremely strong for a SaaS product, driven by the viral scheduling network effect reducing paid marketing dependency.

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

8. Go-to-Market Strategy

Phase 1: DMV Beta (Months 1–6)

Target 10–20 youth soccer teams in the Washington D.C. / Maryland / Virginia metro area. The DMV has a dense, competitive youth soccer ecosystem and serves as an ideal closed-loop test environment. Key goals:

- Validate the cross-team scheduling negotiation protocol with real opposing teams
- Measure time-saved per manager per week (the core value metric)
- Identify the highest-friction scheduling scenarios (weather cancellations, tournament scheduling)
- Collect testimonials and case studies for club director sales conversations

Phase 2: Club Director Sales (Months 4–12)

Use bottom-up rec manager adoption to create top-down club pressure. When 6–10 teams within a club are using FieldIQ, approach the club director with: aggregate scheduling analytics, manager retention data, and a club licensing proposal that costs less than a part-time admin hire.

Phase 3: National Expansion via Soccer → Multi-Sport (Year 2+)

Replicate the DMV playbook in 3–5 additional metro areas. Add lacrosse, baseball, and basketball as second vertical — same scheduling pain, same agent applicability, much larger total market.

Acquisition Channels

- Scheduling network effect — every cross-team coordination event is a natural demo of the platform's superiority
- Facebook Groups and NextDoor — youth sports parent communities are active and recommendation-driven
- Club director outreach — direct sales to club admins once team-level adoption in their org reaches 20%+
- Youth soccer associations — MSYSA, USSF state affiliates as distribution partners
- App Store optimization for 'youth sports team manager' and related queries

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

9. Technology Stack

Designed for a sole developer with deep expertise in Kotlin/Spring Boot, Node.js/TypeScript, Kubernetes, AWS, and PostgreSQL. The stack leverages existing knowledge to minimize ramp-up time and maximize development velocity.

Layer	Technology	Rationale
API Backend	Kotlin Spring Boot	Type-safe, performant, mature ecosystem; existing expertise
Agent Orchestration	LangGraph (Python) or TypeScript AI SDK	State machine-based agents; supports multi-step scheduling negotiation
Mobile Frontend	React Native (Expo)	Single codebase for iOS + Android; fast iteration
Web Companion	React + TypeScript	Club director dashboard; shared component library with mobile
Primary Database	PostgreSQL 16	Relational scheduling data; existing deep expertise
Cache / Sessions	Redis (ElastiCache)	Real-time availability state, session management
Message Queue	AWS SQS + Lambda	Async agent task execution; decouples scheduling workers
Push Notifications	Firebase Cloud Messaging	Cross-platform; free at MVP scale
Calendar Sync	Google Calendar API, MS Graph, CalDAV	Availability ingestion from all major calendar platforms
LLM Provider	Anthropic Claude (primary)	Best-in-class reasoning for scheduling negotiation; tiered models for cost optimization
Infrastructure	AWS ECS Fargate + RDS + S3	Leverages existing AWS/ECS/Fargate expertise from consulting work
CI/CD	GitHub Actions + ECR	Automated build/deploy pipeline; existing DevOps expertise
Monitoring	CloudWatch + Grafana Cloud	Cost-effective observability at MVP scale

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

10. Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
LLM API costs spiral at scale	Medium	High	Tiered model usage, caching, rule-based fallbacks for routine tasks
Scheduling network effect slow to materialize	Medium	High	Manual outreach to opposing teams; offer free accounts to non-users to lower barrier
TeamSnap ONE (launched late 2025) accelerates AI features into cross-team scheduling territory	High	High	TeamSnap ONE is a platform rebuild, not a ground-up agentic system — cross-team negotiation protocol is proprietary and requires network adoption TeamSnap cannot fast-follow. Ship MVP before Q4 2026. Conduct quarterly competitor scan (see below).
Low willingness to pay at rec manager level	High	Medium	Free tier + freemium conversion; primary revenue from clubs, not individuals
Calendar API rate limits or policy changes	Low	Medium	Multi-provider fallback (Google + Apple + Outlook); local availability cache
Sole developer bus factor / burnout	Medium	High	Modular architecture enables contractor augmentation; document core systems thoroughly
Data privacy / COPPA compliance (minors data)	Medium	High	No direct minor PII storage; parent-only accounts; legal review before launch
Field booking API fragmentation (no standard)	High	Medium	Manual field entry as fallback; direct integrations with top-5 DMV facilities in beta
Competitive blind spots (new entrants, stealth AI startups, TeamSnap ONE feature expansion)	Ongoing	High	Mandatory quarterly competitor scan (see Competitive Intelligence Protocol below). Adjust roadmap priority based on findings each quarter.

Competitive Intelligence: Quarterly Scan Protocol

Given that TeamSnap ONE launched in late 2025 with an explicit AI mandate, Otto Sport AI launched in January 2026 with $16.5M in seed funding and a veteran team from SportsEngine and TeamSnap, and LeagueApps is actively adding AI scheduling features — the window for FieldIQ to establish a proprietary cross-team negotiation moat is 12–18 months, not 24. Competitive monitoring is an operational discipline. The following quarterly scan must be completed at the start of each quarter before any roadmap planning session.

Platforms to Monitor Every Quarter

Platform	Current AI Status	Threat to FieldIQ Moat	Watch Signal
TeamSnap ONE	AI-powered internal tools (late 2025 rebuild). Not yet at cross-team agentic negotiation. PRIMARY watch target.	HIGH — large user base, funding, AI roadmap explicit	Any announcement of cross-team scheduling, inter-org coordination, or “scheduling negotiation” feature
PlayMetrics	Fully manual as of early 2026. Club-focused, deep soccer	MEDIUM — club relationships are strong but product is static	Any AI product announcement, funding round, or acquisition activity

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

	relationships. No agentic layer.		
SportsEngine / NBC Sports	Enterprise-focused, manual tooling. Slow to innovate due to NBC Sports parent structure.	LOW-MEDIUM — massive org overhead slows AI adoption	Divestiture from NBC Sports, standalone AI product launch, or major pricing change
Stealth AI startups / YC-backed	Unknown — the highest-risk blind spot. Monitor ProductHunt, YC batches, and App Store new entrants quarterly.	HIGH — well-funded startup with same thesis could compress the launch window significantly	YC batch announcements, ProductHunt launches, App Store search results for “youth sports scheduling AI”
Otto Sport AI	$16.5M seed (Jan 2026). Otto Pilot chatbot for club comms/admin. 3 acquisitions. Soccer/volleyball/lacrosse focus. PRIMARY NEW THREAT.	HIGH — funded, ex-TeamSnap/SportsEngine team, explicit AI OS roadmap targeting your exact verticals	Any announcement of inter-team scheduling, cross-org negotiation, or field booking agent. Check ottosport.ai monthly.
Fastbreak AI Compete	Full AI tournament scheduling engine (Jun 2025). 12+ orgs live, 40+ committed 2026. Pro-level matchup/venue optimization.	MEDIUM — tournament-only today; could expand to season team management	Any product launch outside tournament scheduling (season management, team-day coordination, rec league support)
LeagueApps	AI Schedule Importer live (2025). Whippy AI comms integration. Facility management. Most aggressive AI incumbent.	MEDIUM-HIGH — has club distribution + active AI roadmap; closest incumbent to real automation	Any cross-team autonomous feature, agentic scheduling announcement, or major soccer club wins
TeamLinkt / Emi AI	Emi scheduling/comms assistant embedded in existing team management app. Bolt-on today but positioned as AI assistant.	MEDIUM — has live users + embedded AI; closer to FieldIQ product than it appears	Emi feature expansion into cross-team coordination, field booking, or autonomous rescheduling

Quarterly Scan Checklist (30-Minute Task)

- Review TeamSnap ONE release notes and blog posts for any mention of scheduling automation, inter-team features, or API partnerships
- Search App Store for “youth sports scheduling” and “team manager AI” — screenshot top results, note new entrants
- Check YC batch announcements (ycombinator.com/companies) filtered to “sports” and “scheduling”
- Review PlayMetrics and SportsEngine product pages for any AI feature announcements
- Search Crunchbase / PitchBook for recent funding rounds tagged “youth sports” or “sports management”
- Log findings in a one-page competitive snapshot doc; update roadmap priority if any watch signal is triggered

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

11. Development Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Deliverables
Phase 0: Foundation	Months 1–2	Entity formation (S-corp), domain/brand, core data model, auth system, basic team roster and schedule CRUD
Phase 1: MVP + Cross-Team Protocol (PRIORITY SHIFT)	Months 1–4 (compressed)	React Native app (iOS priority), Scheduling Agent v1 (calendar sync + availability detection), Communication Agent (reminders + RSVPs), basic club admin view. CRITICAL ADDITION: Cross-team negotiation protocol v1 built alongside MVP — two FieldIQ instances negotiate schedule in DMV beta environment. This is the founding differentiator and must ship with MVP, not after.
Phase 2: DMV Beta Launch + Otto Watch	Months 4–7	Full beta launch with 15–25 DMV soccer teams now that cross-team protocol shipped in Phase 1. Field Agent v1 (manual field entry + notification). COMPETITIVE TRIGGER: If Otto Sport AI announces inter-team scheduling features before Phase 2 completes, accelerate to paid launch immediately and prioritize network density over feature polish.
Phase 3: Monetization	Months 7–10	Stripe payment processing integration, Manager Pro + AI Concierge subscription tiers, Club licensing dashboard, App Store submission
Phase 4: Growth Features	Months 10–14	Tournament scheduling SKU, Android optimization, facility booking API integrations, multilingual support, referral program
Phase 5: National Expansion	Year 2	Multi-sport support (lacrosse, baseball), additional metro areas, SportsEngine/TeamSnap data migration tools, partnership program with soccer clubs

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026

12. Conclusion

FieldIQ represents a genuine product category shift in youth sports management — not a better spreadsheet, but a system that performs the work. The timing is right: LLM capabilities have reached the point where autonomous multi-party scheduling negotiation is technically feasible, yet no incumbent has moved to capture this opportunity. The network effect built into the cross-team scheduling protocol creates a compounding moat that becomes harder to replicate with every team onboarded.

With a sole developer possessing full-stack, cloud infrastructure, and DevOps expertise, the path to a working MVP is clear and the infrastructure cost floor is manageable ($150–$300/month). The monetization model avoids dependency on volunteer managers as primary payers, instead targeting competitive clubs, rec departments, and tournament operators — segments with real software budgets and quantifiable ROI from the platform.

The business does not require venture funding to reach profitability. A disciplined bootstrap path targeting break-even by month 18 and $500K+ ARR by year 3 is achievable with focused execution on the DMV launch market and the club director sales motion.

Next Steps

1. Incorporate FieldIQ as an S-corp (leverage existing structure if possible) | 2. Secure fieldiq.com or similar domain | 3. Begin core data model design (teams, events, availability, negotiation protocol) | 4. Identify 5–10 beta manager contacts in DMV youth soccer community (your wife is contact #1) | 5. Set up AWS infrastructure baseline using existing ECS/RDS expertise

© 2026 FieldIQ, Inc. All rights reserved.Confidential — FieldIQ, Inc. 2026